

Active has made good progress, and already has its second release. In 2012, it is expected that KDE will announce Plasma Active available preinstalled on tablets, so that it can expand in scope beyond just the few geeks who know how to install multiple OSs on their tablet devices.

Android

Android tablets still haven't taken off as well as their iOS counterparts, but will Android 4 change that trend? 2012 is when we would find out. Android has become increasingly important in the mobile segment, and being free and open source means that it is quite likely to be found on lower-end tablets. Android tablets will be able to beat Apple ones in price if nothing else, and sometimes that is enough, especially in India.

Tizen

From the ashes of Nokia's Maemo, and Intel's Moblin, and their child MeeGo, comes Tizen. A fresh new project, that has the same goal as its ancestors, to run on mobile, tablet, netbooks, IVI systems and TVs. Tizen, however, is intended to be based entirely on web standards. It is similar to Mozilla's Boot to Gecko and webOS in many respects. 2012 will see its first release, and we will see if Intel can still make a compelling OS.

DESKTOP

Ubuntu

Ubuntu 12.04 will be an important release for a number of reasons. First, it's the first long term release since their new desktop environment Unity, so significant work will go into it to stabilize and refine it. Secondly, it will be the first long term desktop release from Canonical to get a 5-year support period, up from 3 years. Canonical is also working on mobile / tablet versions of the OS, which should also see some activity in 2012.

Linux Mint

Linux Mint 12 has already shown that it's possible to have a good compromise between the old Gnome 2 and the new Gnome 3 user experience.

"The open source technologies I see gaining momentum in 2012 are cloud computing (CloudForms and OpenShift), Infinispan and cloud storage."

—Anuj Kumar, MD, India Subcontinent, Red Hat India

*pointers

>>Nuggets of cool code at work.



*Plasma Active Two

>>This is an introduction on the use of the first release of Plasma Active. This has a demo on a WeTab device.

Duration > 02:46

<http://dvwx.in/jan-12-p1>



*What's new in "Sonny"

>>This video tutorial shows you how to update your website to the new version of WordPress 3.3.

Duration > 05:39

<http://dvwx.in/jan-12-p2>



*Mozilla's Boot to Gecko demo

>>B2G is being developed entirely in the open. Here's a demo of Mozilla's software platform for mobile phones.

Duration > 01:24

<http://dvwx.in/jan-12-p3>



*jQuery Mobile ThemeRoller Preview

>>This is a preview of the new jQuery Mobile ThemeRoller tool, shown during Todd Parker and Scott Jehl's keynote session at jQuery Conference 2011.

Duration > 06:27

<http://dvwx.in/jan-12-p4>

"Developers believe IBM Watson's sophisticated analytics will transform industries that are managing massive amounts of data."

—Himanshu Goyal, Country Manager Academic & Developer Relations, Career Education & Localization IBM India/SA

As Gnome 3 matures and becomes more capable, it will be interesting to see the direction Mint takes. It has already attracted a large number of Ubuntu users who were unhappy with the new Ubuntu UI.

Qt 5

The popular cross-platform toolkit Qt is about release its fifth major release in 2012. Unlike Qt 4, Qt 5 intends to be a quieter, but nonetheless significant release. Backwards compatibility is being given importance. It will be Qt's first release under an open governance model, with the community controlling its direction. KDE software being entirely Qt based, KDE is likely to have a great influence in the direction of Qt 5.

KDE Frameworks 5

With the release of Qt 5, comes KDE Framework 5. However it will not mean a major release for the KDE software. Major updates to KDE are coming in the way its libraries are organised making them more modular and simplifying it for third-party developers to use only a few of the libraries in their apps.

Lightworks

Linux has few good quality video editors. However, EditShare is offering a professional quality non-linear video editor on a golden open source platter. Lightworks is an Emmy and Oscar award winning video editor, used in movies such as The Departed, Pulp Fiction and Mission Impossible. The source code release intend to be in 2011 has now been delayed into 2012.

LibreOffice

Since the community took over development around a year back LibreOffice has progressed a lot. Lying ahead is an overhaul of the UI to make LibreOffice more modern, releases for mobile platforms such as iOS and Android, and even a version of LibreOffice that can run in a browser via the canvas element. >

Join us on Facebook at dvwx.in/dvwx-fb and post your comments.